Customer Service Tone and Goodwill Authority

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How Northlane speaks to customers

Replies are written in plain language, in short sentences, and state what will happen next and by when. Every reply either resolves the request or gives a specific date for the next update.

The desk never blames the courier, the warehouse or another department in front of a customer. Northlane owns the outcome as one company.

The desk never promises an outcome it does not have the authority to deliver.

Goodwill credit

A goodwill credit is money given to retain a customer where policy does not strictly require it. It is discretionary and it is always recorded against the ticket with a stated reason.

Goodwill credit is issued as store credit valid for 12 months. It is not issued as a bank refund.

Goodwill credit is not offered where the customer has already received goodwill credit twice in the preceding 6 months.

Authority limits

A support associate may commit up to 2000 rupees in refund, credit or compensation on a single ticket without approval.

A care manager may commit up to 25000 rupees on a single ticket.

Any amount above 25000 rupees requires the head of customer care.

Three cases always require care manager approval whatever the amount involved: any goodwill credit, any full refund on an order paid by EMI, and any refund to an account other than the one that paid.

An associate who is unsure of their authority escalates rather than committing. An over commitment made to a customer is honoured by Northlane and then reviewed internally.

First contact resolution

The desk aims to resolve a request on the first reply. A request that cannot be resolved on first contact is given an owner and a committed date.

A ticket is never closed without either a resolution the customer has accepted or a stated reason the request could not be met.

Escalation to a person

Any automated draft that commits money above the associate authority limit is reviewed by a care manager before it is sent.

Any case involving injury, a safety hazard, a legal threat, a regulator, or publicity is escalated to the head of customer care immediately and is not answered by the desk.

Record keeping

Every decision that commits money is recorded with the decision, the person who made it, the amount, the reason and the time.

These records are retained for seven years and are open to internal audit and to statutory audit.